

Suppression of the quadrupole-misalignment false EDM signal by orbit-based methods in a proton EDM storage ring

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In the storage ring proposed for measuring the proton electric dipole moment (EDM), quadrupole misalignments of a few microns mimic a genuine EDM, through a geometric (Berry) phase, at up to a thousand times the target sensitivity of 10^{-29} ecm. The proposed experiment controls this with beam-based alignment (BBA) together with a four-fold measurement — the counter-rotating-beam difference taken at both quadrupole polarities — that cancels the effect exactly when the machine is the same in the two polarity states. Using symplectic spin tracking, we ask what standard orbit correction adds to this program. The false EDM turns out to depend on two distinct parts of the misalignment: an antisymmetric part that distorts the closed orbit, and a symmetric part that the orbit barely responds to. Orbit correction removes the first but not the second, and this fixes its role. It cannot replace BBA, because no orbit-based measurement we test — including the counter-rotating beam separation — sees the symmetric part, whereas BBA does. But added to BBA it can replace the polarity reversal: that reversal is exact only if the alignment is identical in its two sequential states, and a micron-scale symmetric drift between them, which the orbit cannot sense and only BBA can bound, spoils the cancellation — while orbit correction removes the antisymmetric part continuously, reaching the target after BBA without the second pass of the experiment. We give the resulting alignment and drift requirements; the reproducibility of the BBA hardware is left for a dedicated study.

I. INTRODUCTION

A. The frozen-spin method and the false-EDM problem

A permanent electric dipole moment (EDM) of the proton would violate time-reversal symmetry, and its observation above the Standard-Model expectation ($\lesssim 10^{-31}$ ecm) would constitute direct evidence of new sources of CP violation. The proposed storage-ring experiment [1] targets a sensitivity of $d = 10^{-29}$ ecm using the *frozen-spin* method: protons are stored at the “magic” momentum ($p \approx 0.7$ GeV/c), at which the spin remains aligned with the momentum as the beam circulates. An EDM then reveals itself as a slow rotation of the spin out of the ring plane, driven by the radial electric bending field. The measured quantity is the out-of-plane precession rate,

$$f \equiv \frac{dS_y}{dt}, \quad d = 10^{-29} \text{ e} \cdot \text{cm} \leftrightarrow f \approx 1 \text{ nrad/s.} \quad (1)$$

Any competing effect that rotates the spin out of plane at this level must be eliminated or bounded; such effects are referred to as *false EDM* signals.

The subject of this paper is the false EDM generated by transverse misalignments of the focusing quadrupoles, a systematic studied for an all-electric version of the ring in Ref. [2] and central to the error budget of Ref. [1]. A quadrupole has zero field on its magnetic axis, so a beam passing off-axis experiences a field proportional to the offset. A vertical offset dy exposes the beam to a radial magnetic field, which precesses the spin about the radial axis and can therefore tilt it out of the ring plane. A horizontal offset dx exposes the beam to a vertical field,

which precesses the spin about the vertical axis; this precession is confined to the ring plane and, like the in-plane precession of the frozen-spin condition itself, does not accumulate in S_y . Either precession alone is nearly harmless: averaged around the ring, its out-of-plane effect largely cancels. When both are present, however, the two precessions do not commute — precessing first about the radial axis and then about the vertical axis is not the same operation as the reverse — and the residue of this non-commutativity accumulates turn after turn as a net rotation about the third axis, which is precisely the out-of-plane direction in which the EDM is sought. This is a geometric (Berry) phase, and its leading dependence is

$$f_{\text{false}} \propto dx \cdot dy \implies f_{\text{false}} \propto \sigma^2 \quad (2)$$

for misalignments of rms size σ . We verify the quadratic scaling directly in Sec. II B (measured exponent $p = 2.00 \pm 0.01$, in agreement with Fig. 9(a) of Ref. [1]). At a realistic alignment of $\sigma = 10 \mu\text{m}$ the false EDM is of order a thousand times the target of Eq. (1), and it appears in the same observable, dS_y/dt , as the genuine signal.

B. The ring

The lattice studied here is the symmetric-hybrid ring of Ref. [1]: electric bending with magnetic focusing. The ring ($R_0 = 95.49$ m) consists of 24 identical FODO cells. Each cell contains a horizontally focusing quadrupole (QF) and a horizontally defocusing quadrupole (QD) — both *magnetic*, with gradients of equal magnitude ($g \approx 0.2$ T/m) and opposite sign — separated by field-

free drifts and by the *electric* bending deflectors:

$$\begin{aligned} & \text{QF} \rightarrow \text{drift} \rightarrow \text{deflector} \rightarrow \text{drift} \rightarrow \text{QD} \\ & \rightarrow \text{drift} \rightarrow \text{deflector} \rightarrow \text{drift} \rightarrow (\text{QF} \dots) \end{aligned}$$

The deflectors are cylindrical electrostatic capacitors that bend the beam in the horizontal plane; at the magic momentum their radial field also freezes the in-plane spin precession. Two properties of this arrangement matter for what follows. First, between any two neighboring quadrupoles the beam traverses a deflector: the deflectors bend and weakly focus the beam *horizontally*, while in the *vertical* plane they act, to a very good approximation, as field-free drifts. Second, the alternating QF/QD gradients make the two transverse planes behave identically in the idealized lattice, with betatron tunes $Q_x \approx Q_y \approx 2.3$ (the tune is the number of transverse oscillations per revolution).

C. The proposed control program and the question of this paper

The design study of Ref. [1] already specifies a program to control this systematic, with two ingredients. The first is *beam-based alignment* (BBA): the accelerator community locates individual quadrupole centers by varying the quadrupole gradient and finding the beam position at which the orbit stops responding, a procedure accelerated with ac excitation [5] and parallelized over many magnets [6]. The second is a *four-fold measurement*: the genuine EDM is odd under beam reversal, so the counter-rotating difference of the two stored beams isolates it from common-mode systematics [Eq. (C1) of Ref. [1]], and repeating that difference with the polarity of all focusing quadrupoles reversed [its Eq. (C2)] cancels the magnetic-lattice false EDM exactly — provided the machine presents the same misalignment in both polarity states. This four-fold cancellation is powerful, but it is not free: the two polarity states cannot be stored at once, so the experiment must be run a second time at reversed polarity, and, as we show in Sec. VI, the cancellation is undone by any change of alignment between the two runs.

Against this backdrop the natural question is what *standard orbit correction* — flattening the closed orbit with steering elements, guided by the singular-value decomposition of the response matrix, routine since the work of Chung, Decker, and Evans [3], and continuous and non-invasive during data taking — can contribute. The closed orbit is read by beam position monitors (BPMs) at each of the 48 quadrupoles; related tools include orbit-response modeling under degeneracy [4], symmetry correction [7], and on-line response-matrix refinement [8]. None of these techniques is new in itself. What we examine is how each performs on the specific misalignment component that drives the false EDM in this ring, and the result is structured: it fixes both what

orbit correction *cannot* do (replace BBA) and what it *can* (replace the polarity reversal).

D. Findings and outline

Three results organize the paper.

First, *the false EDM has a structure that a single alignment tolerance cannot capture* (Sec. III). It is a bilinear functional of the horizontal and vertical misalignment patterns, and each pattern separates into an *antisymmetric* component (neighboring QF and QD displaced oppositely), which produces a large orbit distortion, and a *symmetric* component (QF and QD displaced together), whose orbit signature is suppressed by up to two orders of magnitude mode by mode. Orbit correction removes the antisymmetric component and leaves the symmetric one; at fixed rms σ the false EDM varies by more than an order of magnitude with which component the misalignment carries.

Second, *orbit correction cannot replace BBA* (Sec. IV). The symmetric component cannot be recovered from orbit readings by response-matrix inversion or amplitude-readout techniques, for coherent reasons independent of BPM technology, and the counter-rotating beam separation, being an orbit observable, shares this blindness. Null-finding BBA, which locates each magnetic center by a local zero crossing rather than a global inverse, is not subject to the visibility gap and does reach the symmetric component (Sec. V).

Third, *added to BBA, orbit correction can replace the polarity reversal* (Sec. VI). The four-fold combination cancels the false EDM exactly when the machine is identical in the two polarity states, but that identity is fragile: a micron-scale symmetric alignment drift between the two sequential states re-opens the false EDM to tens of times the target, and that drift is invisible to the orbit — only BBA bounds it. Orbit correction removes the antisymmetric channel continuously, so that after BBA the drift-free counter-rotating difference alone reaches the target, without the second polarity-reversed pass of the experiment. BBA is thus required on either path, and orbit correction is what stands in for the polarity reversal.

Section VII examines the operational side — alignment drift, the re-alignment cadence, and the time budget — and Sec. VIII collects the conclusions. The simulation infrastructure and the spin-signal estimator, on which all quantitative statements rest, are described first in Sec. II.

II. SIMULATION METHOD

A. Tracking tools

All results are obtained with a particle-and-spin tracking code that integrates the equations of motion element by element through the fields of the lattice of

Sec. IB, using a fourth-order Gauss-Legendre symplectic integrator; the spin is propagated in the same steps by the Thomas-BMT equation. Symplectic integration prevents the slow accumulation of energy and amplitude errors, which is a prerequisite for resolving precession rates at the nrad/s level over millions of turns. The genuine EDM enters the model through a switch; with the coupling set to $\eta = 1.88 \times 10^{-15}$ the code reproduces $dS_y/dt = 9.81 \times 10^{-10}$ rad/s, odd under beam reversal, in agreement with Eq. (C1) of Ref. [1]. All false-EDM results below are obtained with the EDM switch off, so that any measured out-of-plane precession is by construction a systematic effect. Quadrupole misalignments, gradient errors (β -beating), and roll angles enter the tracker directly as element parameters.

Wide parameter scans (noise Monte Carlo, β -beating sweeps) use a second, independent layer: the lattice functions, tunes, and the orbit response matrix,

$$R_{ij} = \frac{\sqrt{\beta_i \beta_j}}{2 \sin \pi Q} (KL)_j \cos(|\phi_i - \phi_j| - \pi Q), \quad (3)$$

evaluated in closed form from the quadrupole and drift transfer matrices. This analytic layer runs in seconds, agrees with the tracker at the percent level in the vertical plane, and shares nothing with it except the configuration file, so that agreement between the two cannot arise from a common implementation error. Two of its limitations play a role later and are recorded here: it treats the electric deflectors as field-free drifts, which is accurate vertically but not horizontally (Sec. V); and an idealized response matrix can misrepresent the real beam dynamics, so wherever a response matrix enters quantitatively — both the inverse problems of Sec. IV and the steering of the BBA of Sec. V — it is rebuilt from tracking, and the fidelity this demands is itself one of our results (Sec. VB).

B. Measuring the false EDM

The quantity of interest is the secular slope of $S_y(t)$. Extracting it reliably requires care, because the betatron oscillation of the tracked particle feeds oscillatory components into the spin motion that exceed the sought slope by orders of magnitude. Two measures are combined.

First, the tracked particle is placed on the closed orbit, where no betatron oscillation is present. The misalignment-distorted closed orbit is found by Newton iteration in a few steps.

Second, the spin history is fit with the model $S_y(t) = a + bt + \sum_k [c_k \cos \omega_k t + d_k \sin \omega_k t]$, and only the secular slope b is retained; residual oscillatory content is absorbed by the harmonic terms rather than biasing the slope, as it would in a plain polynomial fit.

The estimator was validated in three independent ways: (i) scanning $\sigma = 2.5\text{--}10 \mu\text{m}$ yields $|f| \propto \sigma^p$ with $p = 2.00 \pm 0.01$, the pure quadratic scaling of

a geometric phase with no linear leakage; specifically, at $\sigma = 5 \mu\text{m}$ after orbit correction we measure $f = 0.62 \times 10^{-9}$ rad/s (median of 3 random seeds) compared to 2.72×10^{-9} rad/s at $\sigma = 10 \mu\text{m}$, giving an observed ratio of 4.36 in agreement with the σ^2 prediction of 4.0; (ii) under sign flips of the misalignment pattern the measured f obeys $f(+dx, -dy) = -f(+dx, +dy)$ and $f(-dx, -dy) = +f(+dx, +dy)$ at the 10^{-3} level, confirming the bilinear character of Eq. (2); (iii) the average of four particles launched symmetrically around the closed orbit reproduces the single on-orbit result within 1%.¹

III. WHAT ORBIT CORRECTION REMOVES, AND THE FLOOR IT LEAVES

A. The residual after standard correction

For random misalignments of $\sigma = 10 \mu\text{m}$ in both planes, the raw false EDM is of order 10^3 times the target [Eq. (1)]; a representative pattern used throughout this paper gives $356\times$. Standard orbit correction — flattening the closed orbit with steering correctors — reduces the ensemble median by a factor of about eight; combined with the counter-rotating-beam difference discussed in Sec. VI, the residual is about $62\times$ the target ($\approx 6 \times 10^{-28}$ ecm), scaling as σ^2 (Fig. 1). Orbit correction is thus effective but not sufficient, and the remainder of this section identifies what the residual consists of.

B. Symmetric and antisymmetric misalignments

Let the 48 offsets of one plane form a vector v , with QF at index $2k$ and QD at index $2k+1$ in cell k . Within one cell the two offsets can be separated into the part in which the quadrupoles move *together* and the part in which they move *oppositely* — a simple 2×2 operation on the pair,

$$\begin{pmatrix} v^s[2k] \\ v^s[2k+1] \end{pmatrix} = \frac{1}{2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} v[2k] \\ v[2k+1] \end{pmatrix},$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} v^a[2k] \\ v^a[2k+1] \end{pmatrix} = \frac{1}{2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} v[2k] \\ v[2k+1] \end{pmatrix}. \quad (4)$$

The first matrix replaces both offsets by their average $\frac{1}{2}(v[2k] + v[2k+1])$, giving the symmetric part v^s ; the second replaces them by $\pm$ half their difference $\frac{1}{2}(v[2k] - v[2k+1])$, giving the antisymmetric part v^a . The full projectors P_{sym} and P_{anti} simply apply this same 2×2 block to each of the 24 cells in turn (so $v^s = P_{\text{sym}}v$ and

¹ The symmetric four-particle average must be constructed around the closed orbit; constructed around the ideal axis it retains the common betatron component induced by the orbit offset itself and fails by orders of magnitude.

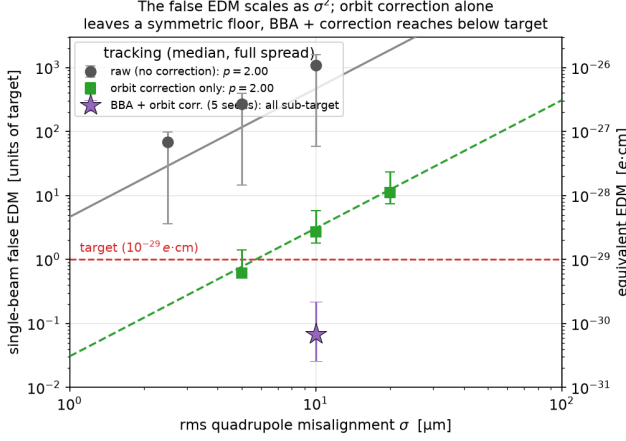


FIG. 1. The single-beam false EDM versus rms misalignment (tracking; median and full spread). Circles: the raw pattern (no correction). Squares: orbit correction alone, which removes the antisymmetric channels but leaves the symmetric floor — still a few times the target at $\sigma = 10 \mu\text{m}$. Both scale as σ^2 ($p = 2.00$ at each stage), confirming the geometric-phase origin; the fit verifies the scaling, not an absolute floor, since at fixed σ the false EDM varies by more than an order of magnitude with the symmetric/antisymmetric content of the pattern (Sec. III C). Star: the full scheme — beam-based alignment followed by one orbit correction (fixed truncated-SVD depth, $\text{rcond} = 0.01$) — evaluated over five misalignment seeds at $\sigma = 10 \mu\text{m}$; all five fall below the target, with median $0.07\times$ and worst case $0.22\times$ (Table II).

$v^a = P_{\text{anti}}v$); they are complementary, $P_{\text{sym}} + P_{\text{anti}} = I$. The same pair of matrices is applied independently to the horizontal and to the vertical offset vectors.

Carrying this out for all 24 cells re-expresses the 48 offsets of one plane as 24 symmetric numbers $m_k = \frac{1}{2}(v[2k] + v[2k+1])$ and 24 antisymmetric numbers $d_k = \frac{1}{2}(v[2k] - v[2k+1])$. Because the originals are recovered by $v[2k] = m_k + d_k$ and $v[2k+1] = m_k - d_k$, this is a reversible relabeling that loses nothing ($24 + 24 = 48$): the symmetric pattern $v^s = P_{\text{sym}}v$ collects the m_k (all $d_k = 0$), the antisymmetric pattern $v^a = P_{\text{anti}}v$ collects the d_k (all $m_k = 0$), and every misalignment vector is the sum of exactly one of each, $v = v^s + v^a$. The two families of patterns are orthogonal and each spans half of the 48-dimensional misalignment space, so they form a complete pair of bases into which *any* pattern resolves; applied separately to the two planes this gives $v_x = v_x^s + v_x^a$ and $v_y = v_y^s + v_y^a$, the representation used in the channel decomposition of Sec. III C.

The physical distinction between the two components follows from the opposite-sign gradients of QF and QD. A misaligned quadrupole deflects the beam by an angle proportional to (gradient) $\times$ (offset). When two neighbors are displaced *oppositely* (antisymmetric component), the opposite gradients and opposite offsets combine to kicks of the *same* sign: the kicks add coherently around the ring into a slowly varying deflection pattern whose domi-

nant azimuthal harmonics lie near the betatron tune, and the closed-orbit response is large. When two neighbors are displaced *together* (symmetric component), the kicks are opposite and cancel within each cell; what survives is a cell-to-cell alternation at azimuthal harmonic $k \approx 24$ (one sign change per cell, 24 cells). The closed-orbit response to a deflection pattern of harmonic k follows the gain law

$$G_k = \frac{C}{|Q^2 - k^2|}, \quad C \approx 24.8, \quad Q^2 \approx 5, \quad (5)$$

which is resonant for k near the tune and strongly suppressed far above it; with $Q \approx 2.3 \ll 24$ the alternating deflection pattern of a symmetric component is nearly invisible [Fig. 2]. Quantitatively, a $10\text{-}\mu\text{m}$ -rms random pattern leaves an rms orbit trace of $\sim 100 \mu\text{m}$ if antisymmetric but $\sim 19 \mu\text{m}$ if symmetric (tracking-derived response), and the two traces differ in kind, not only in size: the symmetric trace is almost entirely *leakage*, a few-percent admixture of the pattern into the strongly-coupled modes. Correcting the orbit therefore cancels most of what an antisymmetric pattern produces but reaches only that few-percent leakage of a symmetric one — the symmetric misalignment itself is left nearly untouched, and with it the residual false EDM.

The same conclusion can be read off the response matrix itself without reference to harmonics. The singular-value decomposition of R supplies 48 mutually orthogonal, unit-normalized misalignment patterns v_i , each with its own orbit strength σ_i (pattern v_i produces an orbit of size σ_i). We ask how symmetric each of these patterns is by applying to it the very same projector P_{sym} of Eq. (4): the *symmetric fraction*

$$s_i = \|P_{\text{sym}} v_i\|^2 \in [0, 1] \quad (6)$$

is the squared length of the pattern's projection onto the symmetric subspace, so that $s_i = 0$ for a purely antisymmetric pattern and $s_i = 1$ for a purely symmetric one. Equation (6) thus turns the decomposition of Eq. (4) into a single number per SVD mode that can be plotted against its orbit strength. Plotting σ_i against s_i [Fig. 2, left] shows the strongly-coupled patterns to be almost purely antisymmetric ($s_i \approx 0$) and the weakly-coupled ones almost purely symmetric ($s_i \approx 1$); the overall visibility ratio between the strongest and weakest patterns is $\text{cond}(R) = 193$. Orbit correction, which by construction removes what the orbit sees, therefore removes the antisymmetric component and leaves the symmetric one.

C. The false EDM as a bilinear form: four channels

The connection between this decomposition and the false EDM follows directly from the physics of Sec. I A, with no further formalism. A horizontally misaligned quadrupole precesses the spin about the vertical axis by a small angle proportional to its offset $v_{x,i}$; a vertically

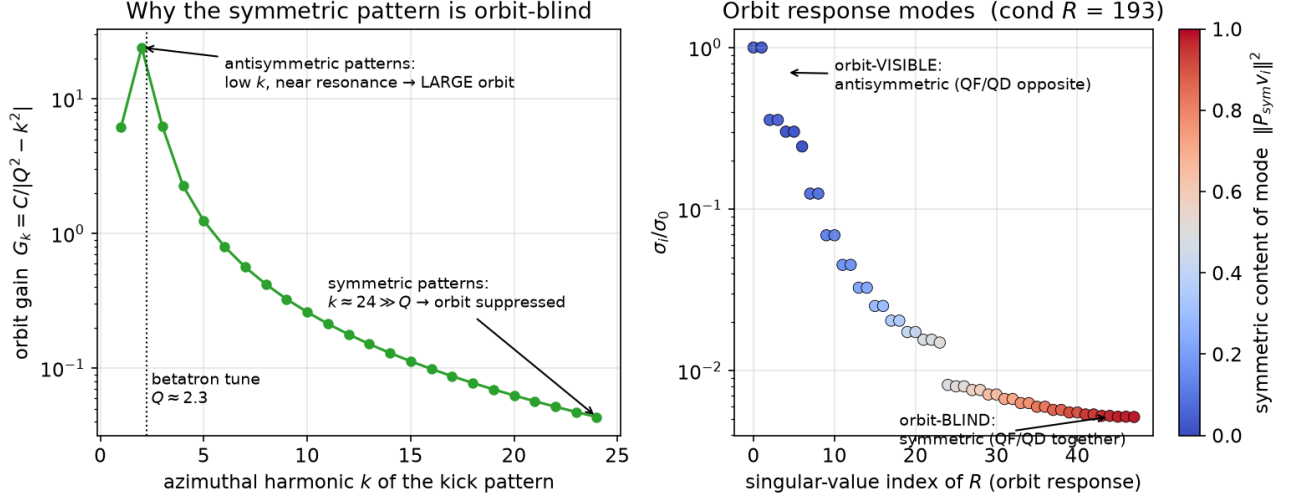
Mode structure of the orbit response (analytic lattice, $Q_y = 2.30$)

FIG. 2. Orbit visibility of misalignment patterns (analytic lattice, $Q_y = 2.30$). Left: the orbit gain law of Eq. (5); antisymmetric patterns drive low harmonics near the betatron resonance, symmetric patterns drive $k \approx 24$, far above it. Right: the independent misalignment patterns ranked by the strength of their orbit response; patterns that couple strongly are antisymmetric (QF, QD opposite), those that couple weakly are symmetric (QF, QD together); the visibility ratio is $\text{cond}(R) = 193$.

misaligned one precesses it about the radial axis by an angle proportional to $v_{y,j}$. Two precessions about different axes do not commute, and the out-of-plane residue left by each ordered pair of them is proportional to the *product* of the two small angles. Summing this over all pairs of quadrupoles around the ring,

$$f = \sum_i \sum_j W_{ij} v_{x,i} v_{y,j} \equiv B(v_x, v_y), \quad (7)$$

where the pairwise weights W_{ij} depend only on the lattice — on where the two magnets sit and on how the orbit deflection started by one is carried around the ring to the other [the orbit response, Eq. (3)] — and not on the misalignments themselves. Equation (7) states that the false EDM is *bilinear*: every term contains exactly one horizontal and one vertical offset, never two of the same plane. This is the sign structure verified directly in Sec. II B.

Splitting each plane independently into its symmetric and antisymmetric parts, $v_x = v_x^s + v_x^a$ and $v_y = v_y^s + v_y^a$ [Eq. (4)], and expanding the double sum, the terms fall into four groups:

$$f = \underbrace{B(v_x^s, v_y^s)}_{f_{ss}} + \underbrace{B(v_x^s, v_y^a)}_{f_{sa}} + \underbrace{B(v_x^a, v_y^s)}_{f_{as}} + \underbrace{B(v_x^a, v_y^a)}_{f_{aa}}. \quad (8)$$

The two planes are mixed by the weights W_{ij} , not by the projectors. Because a misalignment component acts on the spin mainly through the orbit it drives, and that orbit is large for an antisymmetric component and G_k -suppressed for a symmetric one [Eq. (5)], the pure-symmetric channel f_{ss} is by far the smallest, and every channel containing an antisymmetric factor is larger.

We stress that f_{sa} and f_{as} are two distinct physical quantities, not a double counting. In f_{sa} the *horizontal* pattern is symmetric and the *vertical* one antisymmetric; in f_{as} the roles are exchanged. Nothing forces these to be equal: the two planes enter the ring differently (only the horizontal plane carries the bending), and the weights W_{ij} are not symmetric under exchanging the planes, because the order of two non-commuting precessions matters. The tracker confirms the difference directly: for the representative pattern, $f_{as} = -272 \times$ target while $f_{sa} = +28 \times$ — an order of magnitude apart and of opposite sign.

Each channel is a separate tracking measurement, not a fit, and this measurement underlies all symmetric/antisymmetric attributions in this paper. The misalignment pattern (v_x, v_y) is projected once with Eq. (4), and the tracker is then run four times. In each run the quadrupole offsets of the machine are *set to* one projected part per plane — for f_{as} , for example, the horizontal offsets are the pattern v_x^a and the vertical offsets are v_y^s , with no other imperfections — and the estimator of Sec. II B returns that channel's f directly. The weights W_{ij} never need to be known or computed: they are properties of the lattice that the tracker itself embodies, and Eq. (7) enters only through its structural consequence that every term contains exactly one horizontal and one vertical offset, so that the four runs isolate the four groups of terms. Bilinearity is then checked rather than assumed: Figure 3 shows the result at $\sigma = 10 \mu\text{m}$: the four signed channels sum to the full-pattern false EDM within 0.1% ($f/\sum = 0.999$ – 1.001 over three seeds), confirming Eq. (8); the pure-symmetric channel is the smallest in ev-

ery seed; and each channel individually scales as σ^2 . The measured channel ratios are consistent with the bilinear structure: one orbit-trace factor of ~ 5 enters per plane, so f_{aa}/f_{ss} of order tens is expected and observed. The measured channels are used as the quantitative reference throughout.

Two consequences frame the rest of the paper. First, the false EDM is not a function of the rms misalignment: it is σ^2 -homogeneous, but at fixed σ its value depends on the pattern — in Fig. 3 the channel magnitudes at the same $10\ \mu\text{m}$ rms range from $\sim 20\times$ to $\sim 400\times$ the target in the three-seed means, and from $\sim 1\times$ to $\sim 900\times$ across individual seeds. A single alignment tolerance therefore cannot summarize the systematic, and a correction procedure changes not only the size but the *statistics* of the misalignment: it converts a random pattern into a structured one, concentrated in whichever component the procedure cannot see. Second, the division of labor for suppression is fixed by Eq. (8): orbit correction removes the antisymmetric factors and with them the three large channels; the remaining floor is f_{ss} , and any further progress requires a measurement that reaches the symmetric component itself.

IV. THE SYMMETRIC COMPONENT CANNOT BE RECOVERED BY INVERSION OR AMPLITUDE READOUT

Before presenting the measurement that succeeds, we summarize the techniques that do not, and why. All of them attempt to reconstruct the misalignments (including, crucially, their symmetric part) from orbit readings. The realistic error model includes static BPM offsets ($\sim 100\ \mu\text{m}$ each, the electronic zero of a monitor relative to the true axis), white BPM noise ($\sim 1\ \mu\text{m}$ per reading, reducible by averaging), and a coherent optics-model error (β -beating, implemented in the tracker as per-quadrupole fractional gradient errors; the 1% rms operating point used in the tests below produces $\approx 5\%$ rms β -beating (peak $\approx 10\%$) in this lattice, computed from the perturbed one-turn Twiss, so it is if anything pessimistic relative to the $\sim 1\text{--}2\%$ typical of LOCO-corrected optics).

Difference-orbit inversion. Modulating all quadrupole gradients between two settings and subtracting the orbits cancels the static BPM offsets exactly and leaves a linear system $\Delta y = \Delta R \Delta q$. With no errors the inversion is exact. Its weakness is conditioning: $\text{cond}(\Delta R) = 3.7 \times 10^4$, with the weak directions being precisely the symmetric ones (established by the same symmetric-fraction analysis as in Fig. 2, applied to ΔR), so reconstruction errors are amplified along the component of interest. Regularizing the inversion — truncated SVD or Tikhonov damping — does not help here: truncation discards precisely the symmetric directions, trading their noise amplification for a full bias of the sought component. This much is already true *without* any optics error: at the

lock-in noise floor alone the conditioning amplifies the symmetric reconstruction error to about ten times the antisymmetric one (Fig. 4, leftmost bars). White noise can be beaten by synchronous detection — modulating at $\sim 1\ \text{kHz}$ and averaging reaches an effective noise of $\sim 14\ \text{nm}$ within minutes — but a coherent optics-model error cannot: it is identical in every average, and already at a realistic 1% β -beating (a 0.2% rms gradient error) the reconstructed symmetric component is several times the true one ($\sim 110\ \mu\text{m}$ against a $41\text{-}\mu\text{m}$ signal in our standard test) while the antisymmetric component remains accurate [Fig. 4]; the error grows with the β -beat but the symmetric channel is already lost at the low end of the realistic range. Because the limit is coherent, it is independent of BPM technology; lower-noise pickups, including SQUID-based ones, shorten the integration time but do not move the floor. The same structural point can be stated as a bound: any estimator that cancels static offsets by a two-setting difference pays for the cancellation with a $\|\Delta R^{-1}\| \sim \|R^{-1}\|/\varepsilon_g$ amplification, where ε_g is the relative setting difference.

Per-quadrupole modulation read as an amplitude. Assigning each quadrupole its own modulation frequency and reading the per-frequency amplitude at the BPMs — the ac-BBA concept of Ref. [5] — promises a direct, inversion-free readout: a quadrupole whose center is offset from the beam by o_i imprints, when its gradient is modulated, a dipole-like deflection proportional to o_i (the *feed-down* kick, the dipole field component seen by a beam passing off-center). The method fails in this ring for an instructive reason [Fig. 5]. The problem is caused by the modulated quadrupole itself, acting globally. A quadrupole is a focusing element: changing its gradient by even 2% slightly shifts the tune and the focusing functions of the *entire* ring. The pre-existing closed orbit — built by the offsets of all the other quadrupoles, and at $\sim 0.37\ \text{mm}$ rms several hundred times larger than the $\sim 0.9\text{-}\mu\text{m}$ feed-down signal being sought — is re-transported through this slightly altered focusing and moves by a few μm at every BPM. This global response, which we call optics *breathing*, appears at exactly the modulation frequency of the quadrupole being measured, so no frequency filter can separate it from the signal. The reading one then demodulates at a BPM is therefore not the quad’s own feed-down: for the worst-coupled quadrupole the amplitude driven by the breathing of the pre-existing orbit is 266 times larger than the amplitude its own offset would produce, so the number one would invert for the offset is dominated by the orbit of the *other* magnets, and no calibration can recover the right quantity from it [Fig. 5]. Because breathing is coherent with the modulation it does not average away, and removing it in an idealized model restores perfect reconstruction, which pins the failure entirely on this mechanism.

Learned and structured estimators do not escape the limit either: because the misalignment-to-orbit map is linear, a trained neural network, sparsity priors (LASSO, CLEAN), and a calibrate-then-monitor strategy (LOCO)

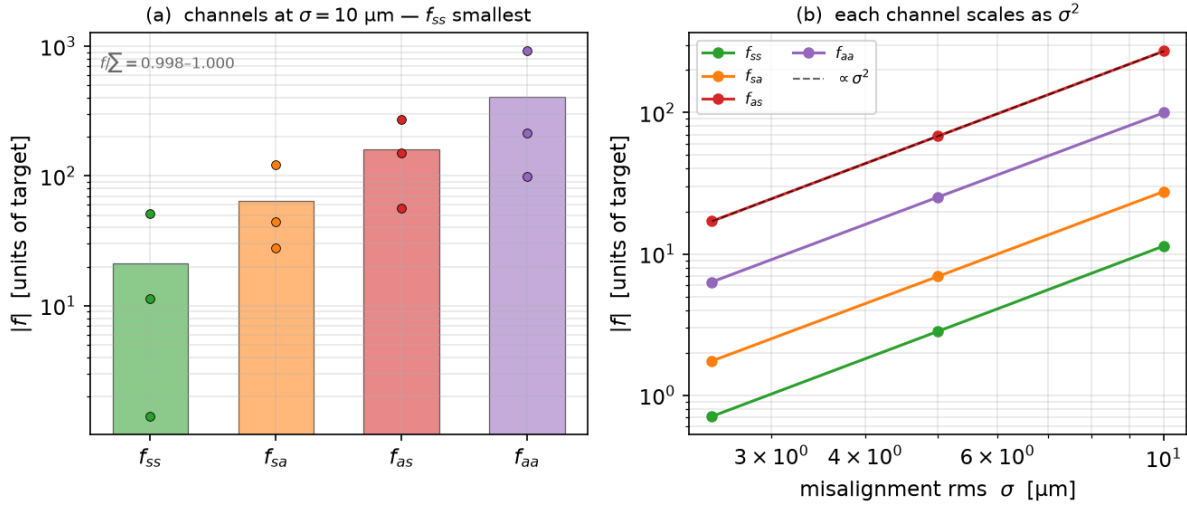


FIG. 3. The four false-EDM channels of Eq. (8), measured by projecting the misalignments and tracking each part separately. (a) At $\sigma = 10 \mu\text{m}$ the pure-symmetric channel f_{ss} is the smallest, and every channel containing an antisymmetric factor is larger (bars: mean of three seeds; dots: individual seeds; the spread reflects the signed, bilinear character of f). (b) Each channel scales as σ^2 . The four signed channels sum to the full signal within 0.1%.

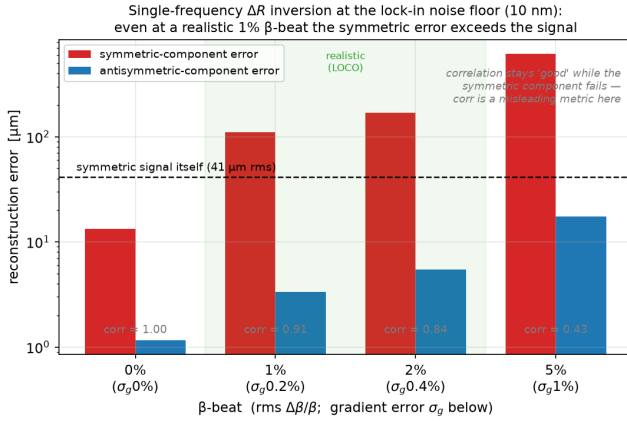


FIG. 4. Difference-orbit inversion at the synchronous-detection noise floor (10 nm, 40 seeds): reconstruction error of the symmetric and antisymmetric components versus the β -beat (the driving gradient error σ_g is $\approx 5\times$ smaller, shown below each label). The dashed line marks the size of the symmetric signal itself, and the shaded band the realistic LOCO range ($\sim 1-2\%$ β -beat). Already at 1% the symmetric error exceeds the signal, while the Pearson correlation (gray labels) stays misleadingly high; even at zero β -beat the conditioning leaves the symmetric error an order of magnitude above the antisymmetric one.

all pass through the same response matrix and inherit its blindness to the symmetric component — in our tests a neural network matched truncated-SVD inversion to within its noise (5.6 vs. 6.3 μm symmetric error against a 9.9 μm signal), confirming that the limit is the information in the data, not the flexibility of the estimator.

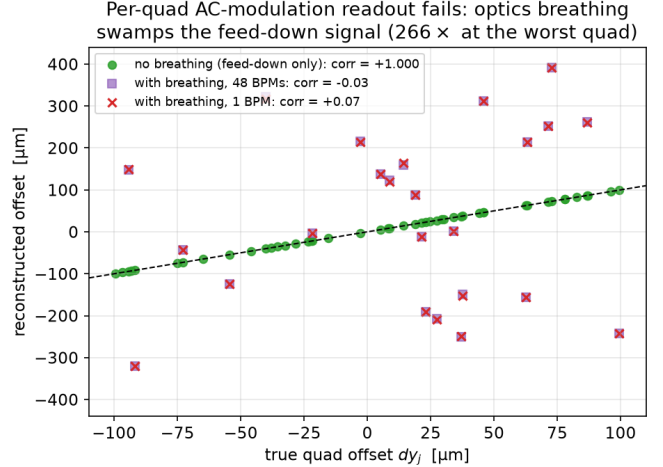


FIG. 5. Per-quadrupole gradient modulation read as an amplitude: reconstructed versus true offsets. The reconstruction is exact when the optics breathing is artificially removed (green), but uncorrelated with it present, whether one BPM (red) or all 48 (purple) are used — the breathing, coherent with the modulation, does not average down.

Counter-rotating beam separation and the tune. The control chain of Ref. [1] monitors the separation of the two counter-rotating (CR) closed orbits and reduces it with correctors. The CR separation, however, is itself an orbit observable and inherits the orbit's visibility structure: in our tracking the antisymmetric-to-symmetric signature ratio is $5.7\times$ in a single-beam orbit and $8.0\times$ in the CR separation (an independent pattern set gives $3.8\times$ and $4.5\times$) [Fig. 6] — the CR separation opens no

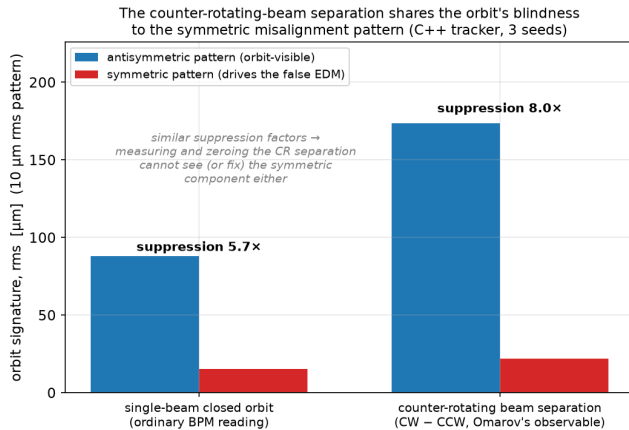


FIG. 6. The counter-rotating beam separation (right group) suppresses the symmetric pattern by a factor similar to the ordinary single-beam orbit (left group): as an orbit observable it shares the orbit's blindness to the component that drives the residual false EDM.

additional window on the symmetric component. The polarity reversal of Ref. [1] is a different matter: it cancels the geometric phase directly, not through an orbit reading, and it does so for the symmetric component as well. That cancellation is central to the present work, but it is exact only when the alignment is stable between the two polarity states; we return to it, and to the role orbit correction plays there, in Sec. VI. Finally, raising the betatron tune toward the symmetric kick harmonic, which would make that component visible in principle, is capped by the stopband ($Q \leq 12$, against the $Q \geq 16$ the slowly-varying symmetric modes require) and in any case raises the false EDM itself steeply (a measured $\sim g^3$).

The common conclusion of this section is structural. For every technique in the inversion and amplitude-readout families, the limiting effect is coherent — conditioning amplified by β -beating, or optics breathing — and coherent effects do not average down. *Within the simulated model, no BPM technology — including SQUID-based BPMs — changes these floors.* We emphasize the scope of this statement. It is a structural property of the estimator classes considered, established by class-level arguments (the conditioning bound and the coherence of the breathing term) together with systematic simulation; it is not an information-theoretic impossibility claim for all conceivable orbit-based measurements. Indeed, the next section exhibits an orbit-based measurement outside these classes that does reach the symmetric component.

V. REACHING THE SYMMETRIC COMPONENT: NULL-FINDING BBA

A. Procedure

Standard quadrupole beam-based alignment does not invert a matrix and does not read an amplitude against a calibration; it locates each magnetic center as the beam position at which the response to a gradient change *vanishes*. For each of the 47 alignable quadrupoles in turn:² (i) using the nearest steering corrector, scaled by the single response-matrix element R_{ij} , the beam is placed at two positions bracketing the expected center of quadrupole i ; (ii) at each position the gradient of quadrupole i is changed by a small amount and the difference of the two closed orbits is recorded at all 48 BPMs — this difference is the feed-down imprint, proportional to the beam-center offset; (iii) since the imprint changes sign as the beam crosses the center, the center is obtained as the weighted least-squares zero over the BPMs, with the spread of the per-BPM zero crossings retained as a per-magnet quality measure. All orbits are read with the beam placed on the 4D closed orbit (Sec. IIB). In the simulation the steering corrector is a controlled transverse displacement of a quadrupole adjacent to the one under test; in the experiment the same dipole kick can be produced without moving any magnet, by a current asymmetry between the quadrupole coils, which shifts the magnetic center electrically. The two are equivalent — an offset quadrupole and an on-axis quadrupole with a superimposed dipole field act identically on both orbit and spin.

The role of the response matrix in this procedure is confined to the *forward* direction: a single, well-conditioned element sizes the steering bump. No global inverse appears anywhere, so the conditioning wall of Sec. IV does not apply; the 47 centers are measured locally and independently, and the symmetric combination of the answers is determined as well as any other combination. An error in the forward element mis-sizes a bump and biases one local measurement — an effect that will be visible below — but it does not re-introduce the collective visibility gap.

B. Idealized and realistic optics

In idealized optics the procedure works outright: the symmetric centers are recovered, and the false EDM of the representative pattern drops from $356\times$ to $1.6\times$ the target.

Under the realistic 1%-gradient-error optics ($\approx 5\%$ β -beat) a single pass fails, through the same breathing

² The gradient-modulated quadrupole of cell 0 is a distinct element type in our model and is excluded; its offset is set to zero and reported as such.

TABLE I. Iterated null-finding BBA under a 1% rms gradient error ($\approx 5\%$ β -beat; tracking, three passes), steering with the idealized analytic model versus the measured response matrix. “sym dx/dy ” are the symmetric residuals of the measured-matrix run. Both runs solve the vertical plane; only the measured matrix also corrects the horizontal one.

pass	sym dy [μm]	sym dx [μm]	$ f $ / target	
			analytic	measured
raw	—	—	$356\times$	$356\times$
1	3.27	4.27	$368\times$	$73\times$
2	1.70	2.90	$238\times$	$17\times$
3	0.91	2.29	$145\times$	$28\times$

mechanism as in Sec. IV: modulating one quadrupole re-transport the large uncorrected orbit through the beating optics and biases the zero crossing. The remedy is iteration — correct the orbit with the current estimates, then re-measure — since a smaller orbit breathes less. Iterating with under-relaxation and the per-magnet quality cut, the vertical plane converges cleanly (residual halving each pass, reaching $0.9\ \mu\text{m}$). The horizontal plane initially stalled, and the diagnosis is instructive. The steering bumps were sized with the analytic optics model, which treats the deflectors as drifts (Sec. II A). Vertically this is accurate, and indeed the model reproduces the tracker’s vertical tune to four decimal places (fractional tune 0.3032 in both). Horizontally the deflectors focus and bend, and the model does not know it: it predicts equal tunes in the two planes, while the tracker’s horizontal fractional tune is higher by 0.052; element by element, the model’s horizontal response matrix is essentially uncorrelated with the measured one (median ratio -0.05), and it selects the wrong steering corrector for 36 of the 47 magnets, against a 5%-accurate response and 12 wrong selections vertically. Re-building the steering from the *measured* response matrix — ordinary practice on a real machine — repairs the horizontal plane: the per-magnet quality ceases to throttle the horizontal corrections, and the false EDM after three passes improves ninefold over the analytic-model steering (Table I). The measured matrix is obtained in the simulation exactly as it would be on the machine: each quadrupole in turn is displaced by a known amount, the resulting closed-orbit change is recorded at all 48 BPMs, and the ratio (orbit change)/(displacement) fills one column of the matrix.

C. Closing the chain: a final orbit correction

The residual of the measured-matrix run — $17\text{--}28\times$ the target at three passes for the representative seed, descending to $\sim 10\times$ by the fifth pass (Fig. 7), and $4\text{--}72\times$ (median $10\times$) across the five-seed ensemble — is not yet the symmetric floor, and Fig. 7 shows why. Across the passes the symmetric residual falls steadily — the ver-

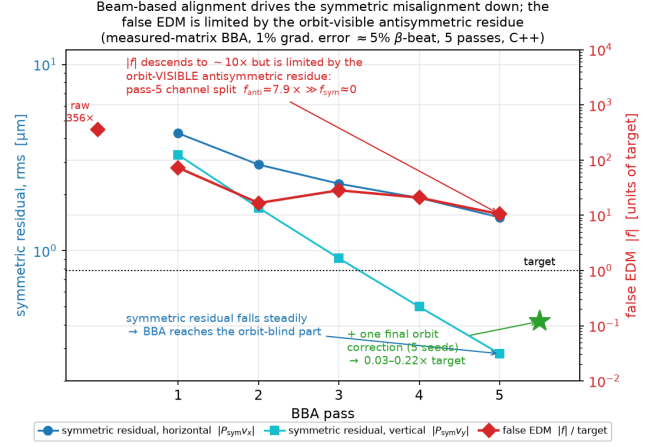


FIG. 7. Beam-based alignment drives the symmetric misalignment down; the false EDM is limited by the antisymmetric residue (measured-matrix BBA under a 1% rms gradient error, $\approx 5\%$ β -beat, five passes, C++ tracking). Blue/cyan (left axis): the symmetric residual of the two planes falls steadily with each pass, the vertical one below the target-equivalent level — BBA reaches the orbit-blind component that response-matrix inversion cannot. Red (right axis): the false EDM $|f|$ descends to $\sim 10\times$ the target by the fifth pass but is limited there, because at the common few-micron floor it is dominated by the orbit-visible antisymmetric residue; the channel decomposition of the fifth-pass residual gives $f_{\text{anti}} \approx 7.9\times$ against a negligible f_{sym} . A single final orbit correction removes that residue (green star: five-seed ensemble, median $0.07\times$, all sub-target).

tical component below the target-equivalent level — yet the false EDM $|f|$ does not follow it all the way down. The reason is that BBA has no preference between the two subspaces: measuring each magnet independently, it lowers *both* the symmetric and the antisymmetric residual, but the false EDM is limited by the antisymmetric part, through its stronger channels [Eq. (8)], while the symmetric part has already reached its target-equivalent size — the channel decomposition of the fifth-pass residual gives $f_{\text{anti}} \approx 7.9\times$ against a negligible f_{sym} . The limit is therefore one of leverage, not of cleaning. That antisymmetric leftover is orbit-visible, so a single standard orbit correction removes it: applied to the BBA residual it brings the false EDM below the target (median $0.07\times$ over five seeds, Fig. 1), and scaling the corrected residual down confirms a clean σ^2 dependence over the tested range.

The resulting picture is consistent and complementary: *orbit correction removes the antisymmetric channels of Eq. (8); null-finding BBA reduces the symmetric channel that orbit correction cannot see; in combination they reach the target, while each alone is limited* ($62\times$ for orbit correction, $\sim 10\times$ for five-pass BBA without the final correction). The division of labor is also one of *precision*: each per-magnet zero crossing carries a $\sim \mu\text{m}$ -level measurement floor (residual breathing and steering-model er-

TABLE II. The suppression chain at $\sigma = 10\ \mu\text{m}$ (single beam, tracking). Rows 2 and 4 are ensembles: row 2 an ensemble median including the counter-rotating-beam difference, and the last row the five-seed distribution of the full scheme (fixed $\text{rcond} = 0.01$, all seeds sub-target, median $0.07\times$); the raw and BBA rows follow the representative pattern (raw $356\times$). The equivalent EDM uses $1\ \text{nrad/s} \leftrightarrow 10^{-29}\ \text{ecm}$.

Stage	$ f $ / target	EDM [ecm]
raw	$356\times$	$\sim 4 \times 10^{-27}$
orbit corr. + CW/CCW	$\sim 62\times$	$\sim 6 \times 10^{-28}$
BBA (measured steering)	$17\text{--}28\times$	$\sim 2 \times 10^{-28}$
BBA + final orbit corr.	$0.03\text{--}0.22\times$	$\lesssim 10^{-29}$

ror), so iterating BBA alone approaches that floor only slowly; the antisymmetric residue, by contrast, needs no per-magnet measurement at all — the orbit displays it directly and resonantly amplified, and nulling it collectively with a truncated-SVD correction (the “depth” above is the singular-value cutoff) is far more precise than measuring it magnet by magnet. Table II summarizes the chain. The endpoint is characterized over five misalignment seeds: at a fixed truncated-SVD depth ($\text{rcond} = 0.01$, chosen once and not tuned per seed) all five fall below the target, with median $0.07\times$ and worst case $0.22\times$ (Fig. 1). Because the false EDM is a signed, bilinear quantity that scatters from seed to seed (Fig. 3), the robust statement is suppression of the whole ensemble below the target rather than any single number. As in any beam-based alignment, the reproducibility of each campaign — the stability of the magnetic centers under the gradient modulation used to find them — is a hardware input that sets how often the procedure must be repeated; quantifying it is outside the scope of this tracking study. The air-core (iron-free) quadrupoles foreseen for the experiment, being free of magnetic hysteresis, are favorable in this respect.

VI. ORBIT CORRECTION SUBSTITUTES FOR THE POLARITY REVERSAL

The systematic-error program of Ref. [1] pairs beam-based alignment with a signed combination of measurements: the genuine EDM is odd under beam reversal, so it survives the counter-rotating difference $(dS_y/dt)_{\text{CW}} - (dS_y/dt)_{\text{CCW}}$, while common-mode systematics cancel [Eq. (C1) of Ref. [1]]. Two beams stored simultaneously make this difference drift-free. A false EDM that were purely beam-reversal-even would vanish here; the geometric phase is not, because the counter-rotating beams ride slightly different closed orbits, and a beam-reversal-*odd* remnant survives. In our tracker this remnant, at $\sigma = 10\ \mu\text{m}$, is $14\times$ the target for a purely symmetric misalignment and $491\times$ for a purely antisymmetric one. Orbit correction removes the antisymmetric part;

the symmetric remnant is the same orbit-blind floor as before, now reached only by BBA.

Reference [1] removes even this remnant with a second knob: *reversing the polarity of all focusing quadrupoles* and repeating the counter-rotating difference [its Eq. (C2)]. Under simultaneous reversal of the beam direction and the magnetic gradient the Lorentz force $q\mathbf{v} \times \mathbf{B}$ is unchanged, so a counter-rotating beam in the reversed lattice retraces the trajectory of a co-rotating beam in the nominal one; the magnetic-lattice false EDM is therefore identical between the two configurations and cancels in the four-fold combination, whereas the electric-field EDM signal, untouched by the polarity reversal, does not. We confirm this directly: the four-fold combination removes the false EDM of *both* the symmetric and the antisymmetric patterns to the estimator floor ($0.009\times$ and $-0.017\times$ the target), independently of quadrupole roll or β -beating, which respect the same $\mathbf{v} \times \mathbf{B}$ symmetry.

The four-fold cancellation is thus exact in principle, but it is not free, and it does not displace the alignment. The two polarity states cannot be stored at once; they are measured in sequence, and the cancellation requires the machine to present the *same* misalignment in both. Any change of alignment between them re-opens the false EDM. Because the false EDM is bilinear [Eq. (7)], the residual it leaves is proportional to the *product* of the ambient misalignment and the drift, so the same drift costs less on a better-aligned machine: after BBA (symmetric rms $\sim 2\ \mu\text{m}$) a $1\ \mu\text{m}$ symmetric inter-configuration drift leaves only $0.07\times$ the target in our tracker, whereas on the raw $10\ \mu\text{m}$ machine the same $1\ \mu\text{m}$ drift, multiplying a five-times-larger ambient misalignment, produces tens of times the target. The drift that matters is the symmetric one, invisible to the orbit and therefore outside the reach of the continuous orbit feedback that holds the antisymmetric alignment; only a BBA-level symmetric alignment, held by periodic re-alignment, keeps the polarity-reversal cancellation intact. More generally, any asymmetry between the two polarity states — a fractional error ε in reproducing the reversed gradients, or any residual difference in the machine between the two configurations — leaks a fraction of the large common-mode signal into the EDM channel; in our tracking an $\varepsilon = 10^{-3}$ gradient asymmetry leaves about $1\times$ the target on a $10\ \mu\text{m}$ -misaligned machine. This is a requirement on the reversal in its own right. What BBA changes is its difficulty: because the signal such an asymmetry leaks from is the misalignment-induced false EDM, which scales as σ^2 , the same asymmetry that spoils the cancellation on a raw machine is $\sim \sigma^2$ weaker after alignment. BBA and the reversal are thus successive stages of one chain — BBA first suppresses the source, the reversal then cancels its common mode — and lowering the source relaxes, without removing, the tolerance on how perfectly the reversal must reproduce the machine.

Two conclusions follow, and they set the role of orbit correction in the alignment program. First, orbit cor-

rection cannot replace BBA: the symmetric component is invisible to it in every configuration. Second, added to BBA, orbit correction can replace the polarity reversal. It removes the antisymmetric channel — the part the polarity difference would otherwise cancel — continuously, non-invasively, and without a second pass of the experiment, while BBA reaches the symmetric channel that neither orbit correction nor a single polarity state resolves. In our tracking the drift-free counter-rotating difference after BBA and orbit correction reaches $1.6\times$ the target for the representative seed, at the same level the polarity reversal targets, without doubling the beam time and without exposing the measurement to the inter-configuration displacement. Should the polarity reversal be used in addition, the analysis above shows it still requires the BBA-level symmetric alignment to deliver its cancellation — so BBA is required on either path, and orbit correction is what stands in for the polarity reversal. The orbit-correction path is characterized over five seeds above (median $0.07\times$ target, all sub-target); the corresponding ensemble on the polarity-reversal path is left for future work.

VII. OPERATING THE SCHEME: DRIFT AND THE TIME BUDGET

An alignment campaign is useful only if its result survives on the machine. Quadrupole positions drift — thermally and with ground motion — so the corrected state of Sec. V is a snapshot, onto which the machine continuously re-loads random misalignment. We simulated this directly by adding fresh random offsets of rms σ_d to the corrected state and re-measuring the false EDM, with and without orbit feedback.

Without any re-correction the false EDM returns quickly: $\sigma_d = 10\ \mu\text{m}$ restores hundreds of times the target. With *continuous orbit correction* — routine, fast, and non-invasive on any storage ring — the picture changes qualitatively, because random drift is shared between the two components and the orbit feedback continuously removes its antisymmetric part: the false EDM stays below the target for σ_d up to about $5\ \mu\text{m}$ ($0.05\times$ at $2\ \mu\text{m}$, $0.3\text{--}0.6\times$ at $5\ \mu\text{m}$) and reaches only a few times the target at $10\ \mu\text{m}$. Only the slowly accumulating *symmetric* part of the drift requires a repetition of the BBA campaign. The alignment therefore does not need to be *held* at the micron level mechanically; it needs to be re-established at a cadence set by the symmetric drift rate.

These sensitivities translate into a time budget whose absolute numbers require one machine-specific input that simulation cannot supply: the drift rate. The arithmetic is simple enough to display. One BBA pass consists of $47\ \text{magnets} \times 2\ \text{planes} \times 2\ \text{beam positions} \times 2\ \text{gradient settings} \approx 400$ orbit acquisitions; at $\sim 10\ \text{s}$ per acquisition (orbit settling plus averaging) a pass costs about an hour of beam time, and the five-pass iteration with its intervening orbit corrections several hours — of

order half a day with overheads. Continuous orbit correction runs during data taking at no extra cost. The re-alignment cadence follows from the drift rate: if the total random drift is of order $1\ \mu\text{m}/\text{day}$ — a representative figure for a thermally stabilized installation, to be confirmed for the actual site — its symmetric part ($\approx 1/\sqrt{2}$ of it, i.e. $\sim 0.7\ \mu\text{m}/\text{day}$) reaches the $2\ \mu\text{m}$ scale in about three days. A few-hour BBA campaign every ~ 3 days is a duty-cycle loss at the percent level. The dominant time scale of the experiment remains the statistical one: polarimetry reaches the nrad/s level only over months to a year of running [10], and the alignment maintenance described here fits inside that schedule provided the drift rate is not far above the representative figure. The unmodeled hardware floor — magnetic-center motion under gradient modulation — enters this budget as a repeatability limit of each BBA campaign and is the main open item on the operational side.

VIII. CONCLUSIONS

The control program proposed for the symmetric-hybrid proton EDM ring pairs beam-based alignment with a four-fold measurement — the counter-rotating difference at both quadrupole polarities — that cancels the quadrupole-misalignment false EDM exactly [1]. This work fixes the place of standard orbit correction within that program, and the answer is set by the bilinear four-channel structure of Eq. (8) and by the sharply different orbit visibility of the two misalignment components. The quantitative picture is as follows.

(1) The false EDM is a bilinear functional of the two transverse misalignment patterns [Eq. (8)], verified in tracking at the 0.1% level, and it separates into an orbit-visible antisymmetric part and a symmetric part to which the orbit response is weaker by up to two orders of magnitude, mode by mode. It is therefore not characterized by an rms tolerance: at fixed σ it varies by more than an order of magnitude with the pattern, and a correction procedure changes not the size but the *component* in which the residual lies.

(2) Orbit correction cannot replace BBA. In our model the symmetric component is unreachable from orbit readings by the inversion and amplitude-readout families of techniques, for coherent reasons (conditioning amplified by optics-model error; optics breathing) that improved BPM technology does not mitigate; the counter-rotating beam separation, being an orbit observable, shares this blindness, and tune elevation is capped by the stopband well below the symmetric kick harmonic. Null-finding BBA is not subject to these limits, because it locates each magnetic center by a local zero crossing rather than through a global inverse; it requires a faithful *horizontal* steering model — an idealized model that neglects the horizontal focusing of the electric deflectors selects wrong correctors and stalls that plane — and it leaves an antisymmetric residue that a final orbit correction re-

moves.

(3) Added to BBA, orbit correction can replace the polarity reversal. The four-fold cancellation is exact in principle — in tracking it removes the false EDM of both misalignment components to the estimator floor, insensitively to quadrupole roll and β -beating — but it requires the same alignment in the two sequential polarity states, and a symmetric misalignment drift of $1\ \mu\text{m}$ between them re-opens the false EDM to tens of times the target. That drift is invisible to the orbit and outside the reach of continuous orbit feedback; its sensitivity falls with the ambient alignment level, so only a BBA-level symmetric alignment keeps the cancellation intact. Orbit correction, meanwhile, removes the antisymmetric channel — the part the polarity difference would otherwise cancel — continuously and without a second pass of the experiment: after BBA and orbit correction, the drift-free counter-rotating difference reaches $1.6\times$ the target for the representative seed, at the level the polarity reversal targets, without doubling the beam time and without exposing the measurement to the inter-configuration drift. BBA is thus required on either path, and orbit correction is what stands in for the polarity reversal.

(4) Operationally, the corrected state need not be held

statically: continuous orbit correction absorbs random antisymmetric drift up to $\sim 5\ \mu\text{m}$ rms, and only the symmetric drift component requires periodic BBA re-alignment, at a cadence compatible with the statistical time scale of the experiment for drift rates of order $1\ \mu\text{m}/\text{day}$.

The paper thus locates orbit correction within the proposed control program at the proof-of-principle level; it is not yet a tolerance document. The principal open items are the magnetic-center stability under gradient modulation and under polarity reversal (the hardware floor, not yet modeled) and the verification of the quantitative results on other lattice variants. All numbers refer to the symmetric-hybrid ring designed for the proton EDM experiment [1], in a linear model without sextupoles. The structural conclusions — the visibility split, the bilinear channel decomposition, and the two roles of orbit correction — rest on the alternating-gradient focusing common to strong-focusing rings, and we expect them to carry over to other such lattices, though we have verified them on this one.

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